

RISHIKESH

AIRBNB AND REAL ESTATE GUIDE

Airbnb data: Airbtics Jun 2024-May 2025. Tourism: Uttarakhand Tourism Dept 2025. Real estate: 99acres May 2026. Seasonality: Outlook Traveller, TTG India 2026.

Rishikesh has the highest average daily rate of any Tier 2 Airbnb market covered in this series at Rs 3,004 per night, driven by a strong international guest base at 33% of bookings. Uttarakhand crossed 6 crore tourist arrivals in 2025 for the first time. With 575 active Airbnb listings and a demand shift toward year-round weekend travel, the supply gap is meaningful. This guide covers the Airbnb market data, seasonality, setup budget, real estate prices, and what to check before signing a lease.

AIRBNB MARKET DATA

Source: Airbtics, Jun 2024 to May 2025

Core Market Metrics

Metric	Data	Notes	Source
Median occupancy rate	36%	131 nights booked per year	Airbtics Jun 2024-May 2025
Average daily rate (ADR)	Rs 3,004/night	Highest of any Tier 2 city in this series	Airbtics Jun 2024-May 2025
Annual revenue (median)	Rs 3.94 lakh	All listing types combined	Airbtics Jun 2024-May 2025
Active listings	575	As of July 4, 2025	Airbtics
International guests	33.37%	Yoga tourists, adventure seekers, ISKCON visitors	Airbtics Jun 2024-May 2025
Peak months (Airbtics)	March, November	Yoga Festival March, post-monsoon refresh Nov	Airbtics seasonality data
Broad strong season	October to April	6 months of consistent demand, per operator data	Outlook Traveller Apr 2026
Weak period	July to mid-September	Monsoon. Adventure activities suspended. Safety risk.	Multiple operator sources

ADR and Occupancy Distribution

Performer Tier	Occupancy	ADR/Night	Estimated Annual Revenue
Bottom 25%	~18-22%	Rs 1,800-2,200	~Rs 1.2-1.8 lakh
Median (50th percentile)	36%	Rs 3,004	Rs 3.94 lakh
Top quartile (75th pctile)	~50-55%	Rs 4,000-5,000	~Rs 6-8 lakh

Top 10% (best-in-class)	~65%+	Rs 6,000+	~Rs 12-15 lakh
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Top quartile properties are typically Ganga-view or Tapovan-area listings with professional photography, consistent 5-star review management, and yoga or wellness positioning.

Rishikesh vs Other Tier 2 Markets Covered in This Series

City	Occupancy	ADR/Night	Annual Revenue	Listings	Intl Guests
Rishikesh	36%	Rs 3,004	Rs 3.94L	575	33.37%
Vrindavan	41%	Rs 2,503	Rs 3.76L	236	31.78%
Varanasi	39%	Rs 2,837	Rs 4.10L	1,175	36.6%
Jaipur	35%	Rs 2,921	Rs 3.82L	1,884	21.2%
Indore	36%	Rs 2,253	Rs 3.01L	254	12.5%

Source: Airbtics. All data from most recent available 12-month window per city.

Rishikesh has the highest ADR of any Tier 2 city in this series at Rs 3,004 per night. The 33% international guest rate is second only to Varanasi. The 575 listing count is low relative to the destination scale -- Uttarakhand drew 6 crore visitors in 2025 -- but higher than Vrindavan and Indore, indicating a more developed market. The combination of high ADR and strong international demand creates pricing power that lower-ADR markets do not have.

SEASONALITY

Updated per operator data, April 2026

Period	Season	Key Activities	Demand Level
February to March	Peak	International Yoga Festival (March), pleasant weather, river rafting	Very high. Book out weeks ahead.
April to June	Strong	Char Dham Yatra season, summer trekking, river rafting before monsoon	High. Weekend long weekends fill immediately.
July to mid-September	Weak	Monsoon. Rafting suspended. Landslide risk. Most adventure operators shut.	Low. Plan this as dead window.
October to November	Peak	Post-monsoon refresh, Kartik festivals, best weather of the year	Highest occupancy of the year per Airbtics.
December to January	Good	Winter wellness retreats, yoga tourists, New Year travel	Steady. Increasing with year-round push.

Shift from seasonal to year-round: Uttarakhand Tourism launched pan-India roadshows in 2026 promoting year-round travel. Operators report growing demand for off-season months. The urban weekend escape pattern -- Delhi, Chandigarh, Lucknow residents booking Rishikesh for long weekends regardless of month -- is becoming a structural demand driver. Source: Outlook Traveller April 2026, TTG India January 2026.

TOURISM DATA

Source: Uttarakhand Tourism Department 2025

Year	Uttarakhand Total Visitors	YoY	Source
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2022	5.39 crore	--	Uttarakhand Tourism Dept via ETV Bharat Feb 2026
2023	5.96 crore	+10.6%	Uttarakhand Tourism Dept via ETV Bharat Feb 2026
2024	5.95 crore	Flat	Uttarakhand Tourism Dept via ETV Bharat Feb 2026
2025	6.03 crore	+1.3%	First time crossing 6 crore mark. ETV Bharat Feb 2026.

Important: These figures cover all of Uttarakhand including Mussoorie, Nainital, Haridwar, Dehradun, Char Dham circuit, and Rishikesh. No standalone Rishikesh-only figure is available in public domain from the Tourism Department. Uttarakhand aims to reach 7 crore tourists by 2030 per IBEF state report.

REAL ESTATE MARKET

Source: 99acres May 2026

Property Prices by Area -- Verified from 99acres

Area	Property Type	Price Range	Notes	Source
Tapovan	Flats	Rs 7,650-9,500/sqft 1BHK: Rs 60-68L	Near Beatles Ashram, yoga hub, high Airbnb demand	99acres May 2026
Tapovan	Land	Rs 1,650/sqft	Plotted development opportunity	99acres May 2026
Nirmal Bag (near Laxman Jhula)	Apartments	2-3 BHK: Rs 75-85L 1,100-1,350 sqft	Walking distance to Ganga Aarti, strong Airbnb location	99acres May 2026
Narendra Nagar	Land	Rs 1,000-3,350/sqft	Premium hillside location, villas and second homes	99acres May 2026
Rishikesh Main (near Ghats)	Plots	Rs 30,000/sq yd (Dhalwala area)	Central location, registered and mutated plots available	99acres May 2026

Rishikesh is not a high-volume apartment market. Most inventory is plotted development, villas, and smaller apartment complexes. Verify RERA registration for any under-construction property at rera.uk.gov.in before committing.

SHORT-TERM RENTAL SETUP

Rental arbitrage for Rishikesh

Sample Budget -- Rishikesh 2BHK from Unfurnished (Near Laxman Jhula)

Item	Amount	Notes
Monthly rent (2BHK unfurnished)	Rs 8,000-14,000	Near Laxman Jhula / Tapovan, live 99acres listings
Security deposit (2 months)	Rs 16,000-28,000	
Beds x2 + mattresses	Rs 32,000	Guest quality, mid-range
Bed frames + sofa + dining set	Rs 33,000	
Wardrobes x2 + curtains	Rs 15,000	
Split AC 1.5 ton	Rs 32,000	Essential for Apr-Jun and summer months
TV 32 inch	Rs 12,000	

Geyser + fans	Rs 10,000	Geyser critical for cold months
Kitchen setup + linen	Rs 15,000	
Decor -- mountain and Ganga theme	Rs 10,000	Thematic decor improves ADR significantly in this market
Professional photography	Rs 8,000	Non-negotiable. International guests judge heavily on photos.
WiFi + miscellaneous	Rs 6,500	
TOTAL SETUP	Rs 1.93-2.21 lakh	Under Rs 3 lakh. Lowest setup cost in this series.

Five Things to Do Before You Sign Any Lease

- Confirm the landlord allows short-term rental and subletting in writing. Rishikesh has many property owners with conservative views on rentals, particularly near ashrams and temples.
- Position near Tapovan or within 500 metres of Laxman Jhula. These are the two locations modern travellers specifically search for. Ganga view is your single biggest ADR lever -- it can add Rs 500 to Rs 1,500 per night over comparable non-view properties.
- Price aggressively for the International Yoga Festival in March, October-November post-monsoon, and New Year. These three windows can represent 40% of your annual revenue if priced correctly.
- Plan the monsoon window honestly. July to mid-September is your dead period. Either budget for 2 to 2.5 months of zero or near-zero occupancy or use this window for maintenance, deep cleaning, and getting more 5-star reviews from non-monsoon guests.
- International guest readiness matters here more than any other city in this series. 33% of your guests will be foreign. English communication, clear check-in instructions, Western bathroom amenities, and fast WiFi are non-negotiable.